Soulache

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/35492152.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Character:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Angella (She-Ra), Micah (She-Ra), Mermista (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Fluff, Alternate Universe - Modern Setting, Alternate Universe - Modern with Magic, Alternate Universe - Urban Fantasy, Demon!Catra, Food, Humor, Fluff and Humor, Alternate Universe - Soulmates, Romantic Soulmates, Platonic Soulmates, Alternate Universe - Demons, Demons, Fae & Fairies, Magicat Catra (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra) Needs a Hug

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by DeltaFell

Summary

Adora thought her life was pretty normal. She went to college, and lived with her best friend of a decade. f you asked her , she wouldnt say that she believed in the supernatural or anything like that. All that changed on the night she met a woman with blue and gold eyes, cat ears, and a tail.

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

"What the fuck?" the demon said.

"What did you do to me? Why do I feel so weird and hollow inside?" Adora demanded.

"Well you should be dead, I just ate your soul. Are you brain damaged -" The demon punctuated this by closely inspecting Adora's face - "You better not be brain damaged. Brain-damaged people are supposed to give me indigestion."

Adora stared into the demon's yellow catlike eye. "I'm not brain damaged. And what do you mean I should be dead? What? You better explain what's going on here."

"I don't know, okay? I've never even heard of this happening before. Usually we just take your soul, eat it, and you're dead as a doornail. Actually, that gives me an idea." The demon stared into her chest.

"Hey, my eyes are up here, jerk," Adora said.

"No way. I didn't even think this was possible. How could it be possible?" said the demon.

"Uh, what? You better start elaborating really quick, or I'll get my roommate," Adora said.

The demon actually winced at that.

"There's no need for her. Uh, look, you still have your soul. I took it, I ate it, but it's right back inside you. I can still feel the energy I took from you, so I have no idea what the fuck is going on. Uh, no harm no foul?" the demon shrugged, and then winked out of existence.

Adora turned and walked out her bedroom door. She walked down the hallway, and opened the door to Glimmer's room.

She never saw the bat coming for her face.

"So, let me get this straight. You, my roommate and best friend since middle school, are a half-fae demon hunter, and you and Bow, who is also a demon hunter, have kept this from me for as long as you've known me. And then to top things off, you sensed a demon in my room, but didn't do anything to stop me from going in there, even though you knew I'd get my soul eaten? And then, when I didn't die from that, because you felt a demonic presence coming this way, you smacked me with a baseball bat as soon as I came in," Adora said.

"Yeah, that's about the long and short of it," Glimmer said.

"Glimmer, what the fuck!"

Glimmer cringed, "Look, I tried to warn you, keep you out of your room for the night, but I couldn't just outright tell you that there was a demon in your room!"

Adora stared deadpan at her.

"Do you honestly expect me to believe you would have listened if I told you there was really a demon in your room and that's why you couldn't enter?"

"No," Adora admitted. If Glimmer had said that, she might have just charged right in anyways. "But did you really have to hit me with the bat before you checked who it was? That hurt!"

"Well it could have been a demon wearing your skin! They can do that! I can't trust that it was you just based on your appearance, and previously, the demonic presence has been enough to go by," Glimmer said.

"What's even up with that, do I like, smell bad or something?" Adora said.

"No, it's not a smell, Adora. It's more like when you have a really really bad feeling, but more specific," said Glimmer.

"So, like when the vibes are absolutely rancid?" asked Adora.

"Yeah, that about sums it up. It's not typically super accurate in humans, but who knows, maybe one of those times it's been right."

"So, what about the whole I should be dead now business?" asked Adora.

"Oh, right! Let's call my mom," said Glimmer.

Glimmer pulled out her phone and began dialing.

"Wait, so you guys don't have any issues like using modern tech? I thought iron was like a huge deal for fae," Adora said.

"It's a problem for fey, not fae. Fey are the eat-your-face-off-for-shits-and-giggles kind, and they're the ones who are so obsessed with rules, and can't stand cold iron or salt," Glimmer said.

"So, your mom' s cooking?"

Glimmer's phone started ringing.

"It's just that bad on its own. In her defense, cooking is a relatively new invention," Glimmer said.

Glimmer's phone connected.

"Glimmer , is everything alright? It' s well past midnight there," Angella said.

"Uh, maybe, mom. Adora' s soul got eaten by a demon," Glimmer said.

"Oh. Oh no. My condolences, sweetheart. I know how much she and Bow mean to you. I bet losing her must hurt terribly ," Angella' s voice hardened. "Did you catch what the demon looked like?"

"Uh, Adora, what did the demon look like?" Glimmer asked.

"Oh, uh, she had these really striking blue and gold-" Adora began.

"Oh. Adora is still alive? Oh dear this changes matters significantly . Am Ion speaker already , dear?" Angella said.

"Y eah, you're on speaker already , mom," Glimmer said.

"W onderful. Adora, dear, the demon who just recently attempted to eat your soul is, well, your soulmate," Angella said.

Adora made a face.

As if she could see Adora, Angella said, "Now , this doesnt mean that you're fated to fall in love with them, just that your souls are intertwined, and it doesnt mean that they're your only soulmate, most people have at least five, either lovers, close friends, kindly mentors, or some such."

Angella sighed, "Adora, dear , this demon is probably going to be back before long. The current monarch of Hell does not approve of soulmates. She thinks they make demons weak."

"So, why should Icare? They tried to kill me," Adora said.

"Well, you should at least house them for a while, while I try and find somewhere to re-house them. Also, odds are, you're the only way they can eat without killing people, which probably actually matters to them more than it may appear at first," Angella said.

"Okay, fine, if they show back up here, I'll let them stay, for a bit," Adora said.

It was raining the next time Adora saw that demon. It had been four days since the demon tried to steal her soul, and the unpleasant weather had kept Adora inside that morning. In between bouts of thunder that shook the small apartment Adora and Glimmer shared, Adora heard a knock at the door.

She opened it to find the cat-eared demon standing outside, absolutely sopping wet.

"Hey, Adora, uh-" she began.

"You need a place to stay, I know. You can stay with us for a while," Adora said.

"Uh, how do you know about that?"

“Angella told me.” Adora closed the door behind the demon.

“Oh, she did, did she? That’s, um, that’s great,” the demon said nervously.

“She’s going to try and find you something more permanent, but in the meanwhile you’re stuck on the couch.” Adora pointed to their admittedly rather dingy couch. “So, what’s your name? Evidently you know my name, you’ve heard of Glimmer, and you’ve definitely heard of her mom. But I have no clue who you are.”

“My, uh, my friends call me Catra,” she said.

“Alright Catra, some basic house rules: don’t bring any spooky shit to the apartment, don’t leave the milk out, clean any dishes you make, and do your chores when the schedule calls for it.” Adora began heading to the bathroom.

Once inside, she grabbed one of the larger towels they had. Tossing it to Catra, she said, “Here, go ahead and dry yourself off, you’ve gotta be soaked.”

“Why are you being so kind to me? I don’t deserve your kindness,” said Catra.

“W ell, for one, Angella asked me to house you, and Icant just not help her out, but, also, from what she told me, you deserve a second chance,”Adora said as she ministered to a pot on the stove.

“No, you dont understand, Adora, you dont get what Ive done. Im a monster.”

“Okay , yes by some definitions you are a monster, but that doesnt make you some damned thing unworthy of someplace warm to stay and a good meal.”Adora took a deep breath. “Angella told me that youve probably killed people, but she also told me what it was like there, with Shadow Weaver ruling your every move. You knew nothing but what she taught you, Catra.”

Catra looked up at Adora guiltily, “Ihavent, actually . Iked anyone, that is. You were supposed to be my first.”

“Oh. W ell, that’s nice at least,”said Adora, pouring out the contents of the pot into two bowls.

“I Ihelped her torture people. Innocent souls, who knows how she had gotten her hands on them. Iknew it was wrong, but she told me to do it, and Iliked it. What kind of sick fuck do you have to be to enjoy hurting people?”

"You didnt know anything else. You cant blame yourself for the environment you were raised in. Here, this is for you."Adora handed a bowl to Catra.

Catra ate a spoonful, and her eyes opened wide.

"What is this magical elixir you've fed me? It better not be poison, it'd be a capital fucking sin for something so good to be poison,"Catra said.

"It's instant ramen, Catra, have you never had like, actual food before?"

"All we had down there were like these processed soul-ration bars that gave you soul-poisoning every other time you ate them,"Catra said around a mouthful of ramen.

"That's horrific."Adora held a hand to her mouth.

"It's how it was."Catra shrugged.

"Well, then while you're staying with us, you should definitely get a chance to try some more human foods. There's no way I'm letting

you think instant ramen is the best thing we have to offer,”Adora said.

“So, what is this place again, Adora?”Catra asked as they stood outside Adora’s favorite ramen shop.

“W ell, to start things off, Ithought we should go and get like some actually good ramen, rather than just the instant ramen Imade in like three minutes. This place has the best ramen noodles in the city, and they’re also like super authentic. Y ou have to try them, Catra,”Adora said.

“Alright, fine. Ill try these noodles. Idont see how anything could possibly taste any better than the ramen you made for me, but Ill give it a shot,”said Catra.

They walked through the front doors, and Adora directed Catra to one of the booths. While Catra was getting situated, Adora walked up to the front counter. Glimmer was working the register today.

“Hey Glim, can Iget two of the usual today?”Adora said.

“For you and the demon?Why?”

"She has a name, Glimmer ."

"Okay fine, for you and Catra? Why the fuck are you feeding her?"

"She' s never even had real food, a bowl of instant ramen I made her last night blew her mind, I cant just not help her experience actually good food."

"Ugh, fine, you have a point. T wo of the usual coming right up, " Glimmer said.

"Thanks, Glim."Adora walked back to the booth where Catra was now lounging.

"Okay , I got us two of my absolute favorite thing here, you're going to love it. It' s got a hardboiled egg, seaweed, a variety of vegetables and a really good broth,"Adora said.

Catra raised an eyebrow. "I dont see how anything could possibly be better than that instant ramen. It was pure carnal pleasure in a bowl."

"Look, just trust me alright? It' s gonna be good,"Adora said.

They went back and forth for a few minutes, waiting on their food, but eventually, Glimmer walked up with two bowls of ramen.

"Ramen for Adora," she said.

"Well, hello to you too, Sparkles," Catra said.

Adora kicked her underneath the table. "She has to say who the order is for, which is me, because I paid for it. Don't be a dick, Catra, especially not to waitstaff."

"Okay , fine, yeesh." Catra raised her hands in surrender . "I'll be nice to the waitstaff, and maybe also Sparkles."

Glimmer slid the bowls down the table to Catra and Adora.

"Enjoy your meal," she said before leaving.

Catra and Adora dug in. For Adora, it was as heavenly as it usually was. Micah was a phenomenal cook, and as usual, he put his whole heart and soul into making delicious food. Across the table, Catra was slurping her ramen down like a starving woman. Adora chuckled to herself. Catra may be a people eating demon, but she was kinda cute like this, Adora had to admit.

"Hey girls, how' s the food?" Micah asked.

Adora jumped.

"It' s phenomenal, Mister," Catra trailed of f.

"Mr . Brightmoon, but please, call me Micah. You're Glimmer and Adora's new roommate, right?"

"Uh, yeah, you could say that, " Catra said.

"I hope you know that any friend of my daughter 's, or any friend of Adora's, for that matter, is welcome here anytime." Micah smiled warmly at Catra.

"Thank you for the ramen, Micah," said Adora.

From the kitchen, a rather large clattering noise could be heard. Micah turned around immediately. "Well girls, I should get going, but it was a pleasure to meet you Catra, I hope to see you around here again."

As soon as Micah disappeared, Catra turned to Adora, her face a picture of rage.

“Adora what the fuck! You didn't tell me Angella's husband owned this place! Have I been poisoned?” Catra said.

“You haven't been poisoned, Catra. I didn't think it was a big deal. I mean, it's just Angella, I've known her since I was a kid,” Adora said.

“Just Angella? She's literally the faerie queen, Adora, and like, a sworn enemy to all of demonkind.”

“Okay, fine, well eat somewhere else then next time, if it makes you feel that uncomfortable. But I was right, wasn't I?” Adora stood, leaving a tip for Glimmer.

Catra stood to leave. “Yeah, you were right, Dummy.”

“So, where are we this time?” Catra rested her hands on her hips.

In front of them stood an admittedly very sketchy looking building. The doors were covered in spanish signage and grime, and the

space on the roof where the name of the store would normally go was covered in plywood.

"This is T ienda Don Mermista, it has the best tacos you can find in the city, and like, actually authentic ones to boot. Way better than Chipotle," said Adora.

"What' s a taco?" asked Catra.

"Look, just trust me on this and try them. Y oull love them," Adora said, pushing open the front doors.

Adora could hear Catra follow her in without turning around. She approached the counter as Catra trailed behind her.

"Sup, Mermista? I'll take four al pastor tacos, please," Adora said.

"Hey Dor , it's been good. W ould you like cilantro, onions and limes with that?"

"Of course."

"Green or red salsa?"

“Green please. My friend Catra here is new , Idont want to scare her off just yet,”

Mermista threw her head back, laughing. “Alright, thatll be eleven ninety-six, Ill bring those right on out.”

Adora dragged Catra, who stood stock still over to a table. As soon as they were sat down, Catra hissed at Adora, “Are you fucking kidding me? Mermista Salineas? Princess of the fucking mermaids? She hates demons, because one of us killed her parents! Are you trying to poison me?”

“Mermista’ s not a mermaid, even if the name is a really weird coincidence, we went to school together for ages! Besides, Mermista wouldnt poison someone Im having dinner with, not again.”

“Not again? What?”

“Look, it was a while ago, and she saw them slip roofies into my soda, so she poisoned them. At least that’s what Ithink it was. It was kinda fast-acting for a poison. So long as you dont do that, and especially if Itell her youre my roommate, she wont do anything.”

“Leaving that aside, how long did Glimmer have you fooled again?”

“Almost ten years,” Adora admitted.

“So then it’s possible, plausible even, that the Mermista Salineas you know is the same Mermista Salineas that is the princess of the mermaids,” Catra argued.

“It’s possible,” said Adora.

Mermista walked up with two plates of tacos, already loaded with cilantro and red onions.

“So, you Adora’s girlfriend or something?” asked Mermista.

Adora felt a blush climb up well past her cheeks. “No, no, she’s just Glimmer and I’s new roommate. She needed somewhere to stay while Angella looks for a more permanent situation for her.”

“Angella huh?” Mermista looked Catra up and down, crossed her arms and nodded. She turned to Adora. “You sure you two know what you’re doing with her?”

“Y up!”

"Alright." She left the table to man the register once more.

"So, how do I eat these, exactly?" Catra asked.

"Well, first you gotta squeeze out the lime juice and add the salsa, but once you've done that you grab it by the tortillas - that's the flat yellow things - and fold it in on itself. And then you start eating from one end," Adora said, squeezing lime juice all over her tacos.

Adora brought her taco up to her mouth, took a bite, and waited for Catra to do the same.

Catra squeezed the lime out over her tacos before applying a liberal amount of the green salsa. In one fluid motion, Catra scooped up her first taco and took a large bite out of it. Her eyes widened at the taste, and then a few seconds later she began coughing.

"What's happening, are you okay?" said Adora.

"I'm fine, it just burns, but like, in a good way? It's kinda hard to explain."

"That would be the salsa you put all over your tacos which you then took a huge bite out of before I could warn you, although it might also be a little bit the meat in the al pastor tacos. It's seasoned, and that can be a bit much for someone who's never had real food before. I'm sorry, I should've thought of that."

"No, no it's fine, I like it, it's just new is all." Catra took another bite

Adora smiled, feeling warm inside, as she watched Catra eat her tacos.

"Catra, I don't know if that's a great idea," Adora said.

"C'mon, what could possibly go wrong?" said Catra.

They stood outside a bright and imposing McDonald's restaurant. It had been getting kind of late, and Adora had to admit she was at this point rather hungry, however, she was not quite yet willing to eat McDonalds. Her wallet was one of the few freedoms still admitted to her, and she refused to support such a repugnant chain, insignificant as her support or lack thereof might be.

Besides, she reasoned, McDonalds was absolutely awful for you.

"Catra, McDonalds is terrible for you. Frequently filthy , in addition to contributing to an epidemic of obesity and heart failure. I do not wish to contribute towards your death."

"How sweet of you, but I'll be fine. I don't have a heart, remember?" Catra said and sauntered into the McDonalds.

Adora watched her go for several moments.

"That damn demon," she said before following her in.

Adora sat in a corner booth, one that gave her a good view of the whole restaurant, both exits, and the criminally underpaid staff. Just in case someone was going to try something.

"There's no need to be so worried, Adora, it's just a restaurant, what could possibly go wrong?" Catra approached with a burger and fries in hand.

Adora looked around the McDonalds a few times. "I don't know . Something. Anything. I don't trust this place."

"Relax, Adora, everything's just fine," Catra said.

Catra took a bite out of her burger, coughed several times, and fell over.

Adora's heart rate spiked when Catra began falling, and leapt around the table to catch her. Adora immediately felt for a pulse and breathing. The few seconds it took her to locate a pulse and breathing were the longest seconds Adora had ever felt. Adora could have wept when she found a pulse and breathing.

Adora pulled out her phone and dialed Glimmer.

"Glimmer , we're at the McDonald's on 54th and McDougal, Ineed you to get here right away, we need to get Catra back to the apartment."

"What? What's happened Adora, are you okay?"

"I'll explain later , just hurry ."Adora hung up, and picked Catra up by her armpits.

Adora began to carry Catra outside the restaurant so Glimmer could teleport them all home without freaking out the staff.

Catra lied on the couch, wrapped in blankets, while Adora freaked out.

"What do we do? What do we do? We could ask Angella, but then she'd be pissed we almost killed Catra. Oh man I almost killed Catra, oh no oh fuck what am I going to do."

Adora felt an arm on her shoulder.

"Adora, take a few deep breaths, and try to relax. My mom is not going to be pissed with you, she'll understand, okay? Besides, she'll probably be able to help us figure out how to get Catra better again, and I kinda maybe already called her and told her something was wrong with Catra."

Adora glared at Glimmer, but before she could say a word, there was a familiar, regal knock on the door.

Adora went to open it.

"H-hey Mrs. Brightmoon," she said.

"Hello Adora, dear . Is Catra feeling alright? Glimmer told me she was not okay, but unfortunately, that doesn't actually tell me that much." Angella stepped inside.

“W ell, Istarted taking her around the city to some of the like really good but also affordable restaurants in town, and then she insisted on trying McDonald’s, and-”

“And she ended up like this?” Angella guessed.

“Y eah,” Adora scratched the back of her head, looking down.

“Ah. Ithink Iknow what the problem is. Demons cannot ingest food that is not imbued with some fragment of a soul. When you took her to restaurants around town, if you went to the ones Iknow you like, then you probably took her to a restaurant where the cooks genuinely care about the food they make. Inadvertently , they infuse the food with a portion of their soul, and that is why Catra was able to eat it,” Angella said.

“Oh,” said Adora, “and when she tried McDonald’ s, because the employee’s are paid basically nothing and it’s a fast food chain, no portion of their soul is ever infused into the food because they arent paid enough to care”?

“Precisely . Now, if you make her something easy to digest, like some form of soup, and feed that to her, she should start to feel better in a few days.”

f I do that often enough, am I not at risk of losing my soul and then dying? Is that why people die so early in the restaurant business?" said Adora.

Angella laughed, "No dear , that would be all the stress. Infusing your work with a part of your soul does so in a way that you can regenerate it. That besides, Catra is one of your soulmates, so even if she were to somehow consume your whole soul, it would still go back to you."

Adora made a potato and corn chowder for dinner on the day Catra woke up. She'd made some other soups for Catra, including clam chowder, chilli, and tomato soup, but Adora thought this one was her favorite. Catra seemed to respond best to it, at least. She got some color back and her breathing settled into a more stable pattern when she ate it.

Adora was feeding Catra a spoonful of soup when she coughed and opened her eyes. Adora dropped the spoon into the soup and hugged Catra tightly.

"Oh thank goodness you're alright, Catra, I was so worried!"

"Could you squeeze a little less tightly , Dummy?

"Oh right, yes, of course." Adora let go of Catra, but still kept ahold of her hand.

"So what happened? All I remember is that burger tasting like ash, and then the world going dark."

"So, turns out, what food you can eat is a souls thing, and it's really complex and we can go over it later, but no more fast food for you, okay?"

Catra coughed, "Sounds good to me. Dunno why you'd ever even eat that shit, it tastes fucking awful."

Adora laughs and leans in. "I thought I'd lost you."

"Can't get rid of me that easily, Dummy," Catra said.

Adora kissed her, and Catra kissed back.

End Notes

I got swamped today with work, and only processed that it was friday at like 5pm lmao.

Next week is dead week (yuck) but I've got several weeks worth of stories to post already so don't worry, you'll get content next week and in finals week. A huge thanks to everyone who read this, and to Zand Dredgen Grace for the help editing! I'll see y'all next week, when hopefully my eyes won't be swimming with laplace transforms.

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!